

OPERATOR'S MANUAL



A 303-inspired acid engine

ACIDRATCHET MF-303 is a single, self-contained acid-bassline machine inspired by the classic 303. No install, no account, no cloud — open it and it plays. Built and voiced by ear on iPhone and iPad, deployed straight to the web.



Zero install

One .html file. Open it, press START, make noise.



303-style DSP

Diode-style ladder with genuine self-oscillation — the musical “knack.”



AudioWorklet engine

Sample-accurate, low-latency, runs off the main thread.



Mobile-first

Touch UI, tuned on iPhone / iPad. Works on desktop too.



Offline & private

No server, no tracking. Save the file, use it anywhere.

Sound in four moves

1



Press START

Browsers need one tap to wake the audio engine. Hit START — the status line confirms the worklet is live.

2



Load a preset

Pick a signature pattern from the preset row. Instant acid line to play with.

3



Ride Cutoff + Reso

Open CUTOFF, push RESO toward the top. This is where the squelch lives.

4



Add accents

Toggle accent steps. Consecutive accents climb — that's the acid screw-up.

Core controls



CUTOFF

Filter frequency. The main tone control — closed = dark & dubby, open = bright & vocal.



RESONANCE

Filter emphasis (Q). Push high for the squelch; near the top it sits on self-oscillation.



ENV MOD

How hard the envelope sweeps the filter per note. The source of the classic “wow” movement.



DECAY

Length of that envelope sweep. Short = plucky & tight, long = liquid & flowing.



ACCENT

Per-step push: louder, snappier, and a resonance-scaled filter kick. The acid accent.

Shaping & voice

TUNE

Master pitch in semitones.

SQUELCH

Extra dirt and bite into the filter feedback.

SUB / DETUNE

Sub-octave thickness and a detuned second saw for width.

LFO → CUTOFF

Hands-free filter wobble — rate and depth.

BODY

Adds low-end corpus / weight under the note.

DIST / TONE

Drive character and bright/dark tilt — loudness-normalized.

WAVE

Saw, square/PWM, super-saw, sync, sample & hold.

SLIDE / GATE

Note glide and step length, set in the sequencer.

The sequencer

Sixteen steps drive the bassline. Each step can carry a note, an accent, and a slide — that's the whole acid vocabulary.



Steps

Tap a cell on/off. The lit row is your pattern; it loops in time.



Accent

Marks a step for the accent push. Stack them for the climbing acid scream.



Slide

Glides pitch from the previous note — the legato 303 “gliss.”



Patterns & presets

Multiple pattern banks, named signature presets, song-chain playback.



Drums

Four tracks run locked under the MF-303 — own pattern grid, own level, saved with the kit.

CORE

The house character — punchy and clean.

808

Deep booms, long tails, classic sub-kick.

909

Snappy, bright, techno-floor energy.

FOUR TRACKS

KICK

four-on-the-floor anchor

SNARE

backbeat / clap layer

HIHAT

closed ticks & drive

OPEN

offbeat sizzle



07 · THE SECRET

Why it sounds like acid

Accents accumulate. On the real 303 a capacitor charges a little more with each consecutive accented step — so a run of accents **climbs higher and higher**. The filter screams, resets, screams louder. That runaway is the famous “acid screw-up,” and MF-303 models it.

Accent sweeps the FILTER

not the pitch — a resonance-scaled cutoff kick.

Sit just BELOW self-osc

the musical “knack.” Past it = pure whistle.

Stack accents to build

consecutive hits climb — ride them live.

Signature sounds



DEEP BERLIN BASS

Low cutoff, high reso, short decay, a few accents. Dark, round, hypnotic — let it loop.



SCREAMING LEAD

Open cutoff, reso near the top, long decay, accents on every other step. Rides into self-oscillation.



RUBBER SQUELCH

Mid cutoff, high reso, slides between notes, medium env. The classic talking-303 bounce.



DRIVEN ACID

Add DIST for grit, pull TONE dark, push BODY. Fat and aggressive without getting brittle.

Numbers are a starting point — MF-303 is voiced by ear. Trust the iPhone speaker and chase the feel.

Save, deploy, specs



Presets persist

Your patterns and sounds save in the browser — they're there next time.



Deploy anywhere

Drop the file on Netlify or any static host. AudioWorklet wants `https / localhost`.



Single file, offline

One self-contained .html. No dependencies, no network needed.



iPhone / iPad ready

Touch-tuned. Add to home screen and play it like an app.

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